

Overview: The US Average Prices Monthly dataset contains monthly US customer prices for 74 goods from January 2015 to July 2026. The dataset can be used to analyze inflation, price fluctuations and long-term trends. According to the dataset information, changes are calculated using 12-month averages at the end of each time period rather than comparing single months. This approach helps reduce the effect of seasonality and provides a more accurate measure of the price changes over time.

The variables for this dataset are:

- Date, Year, Month, Item, Unit, Category, Price, Series_id
 - The item variable identifies the product, the unit indicates the unit of measurement (pounds, gallons, or dozens). Price represents the monthly transaction price and Series_ID is the unique identify assigned by the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Average Price Data program.

Data Collection Methodology: The data was collected from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Average Price Data program. The dataset contains monthly average transaction prices for consumer goods in the United States. The prices are recorded as actual dollar amounts rather than index values and represent the national average price. This data was collected on a monthly basis from January 2015 through July 2026.

Intriguing: This dataset intrigues me because it shows how much prices have changed in an 11-year period. Price changes are typically difficult to notice in everyday life but examining the data over a longer time frame makes trends easier to identify. I am interested in looking at what products experienced the greatest increases in price and how the categories compare to each other.